



2 Billion Chrome

Google announced that Chrome browser has now 2 billion active users worldwide. <http://dgit.in/chrm2bl>



GoPro Karma recalls

GoPro announced a total recall on all their Karma drones as they were falling out of the skies due to a sudden power failure. <http://dgit.in/krmaRc>

Feature

the genre of music that you create. For instance, if you are producing vintage style music like bebop or classic rock, it would be hard to emulate some of the necessary elements using just digital gear. The reason is that the music in those genres is usually recorded with analog methods and they have some harmonic overtones which are generally associated with the genres. However, creating modern dance, hip-hop and pop tracks shouldn't be all that hard with digital gear.

In fact, these genres positively cannot be created without digital gear.

Helping a larger/younger population make music

The accessible recording setups mean that the recording process becomes available to a larger demographic. This, in turn, creates a middle class in the music recording landscape. Contrary to the earlier days when you had the 'higher ups' and the 'bottom-scrappers', inclusion of the middle class also enables a whole lot of musicians to make their bread and butter independently, without being signed on by any major labels. This independence in turn makes production of more experimental sounds feasible- what with the lesser interference from the 'higher-ups' in the creative process- the kind of interference that messes up a lot of music projects.

This level of accessibility of recording/music producing gear also means that the market quickly became over-saturated (the reason why when you tap open a music streaming platform, you are soon spoilt for choice). However, talent still shines through.

How the humble laptop is a handy device for modern musicians

More often than not, it's the convenience which the digital tech brings that outweighs its drawbacks. And we're pretty sure the convenience-factor is one major reason that veteran artists are shifting to digital from analog (Radiohead and Chick Corea are examples).



The digital tech has helped more young people to enter the music-making arena

For instance, the ability to carry a laptop to different venues across the world and recall the mix exactly as you left it is one of the major benefits for artists working in digital. And this scenario has resulted in the mixes continually improving since they are always being built upon and not mixed from scratch each time a session opens.

But there is also a downside to music-making using modern recording, albeit one that could easily be avoided. The issue is that when you perform all aspects of the music producing process yourself- which indeed you can do with digital tech, the quality of the end-product can be less than what you expected. The reason is that earlier, the recording process and mixing process were two separate specializations- something that helped create better sounding music. In fact, in the olden days, there would be a recording engineer, a mixing engineer, an assistant engineer, a producer and a mastering engineer in addition to the singers and instrumentalists. These days, it's well possible that all these roles would be played by one person- and sometimes, the quality suffers.



The laptop - Convenience on stage

A short look back at the beginning of the digital music revolution

The roots of modern day electronic music, or to be more precise 'DJ-produced music' lies in Jamaica- the small Caribbean island which has been the birthplace of so much great music. Dub, a 'dance-mixed reggae' to put it simplistically, is the genre of music that kicked off it all.

Enter dub music

The dub revolution happened in the country during the 1970s. The popular consensus is that Lee "Scratch" Perry's 1973 album 'Blackboard Jungle Dub' was the first standalone dub album.

Now, the interesting thing about earlier dub albums is that they were almost always created by a limited number of people (often one person) using analog music making machines- including amplifiers. The person would create this music by manipulating the sounds from old vinyl recordings, sitting inside a cramped room in his house. The music would then be pressed onto vinyl and ready to be played in open air concerts held in the night. These concerts would be performed by just one person- you can consider him the DJ playing the music, sometimes manipulating the sounds live for an audience dancing under the shimmering stars.

Dub music- like many cool things in the world, came out of necessity. There never existed concert avenues for the ordinary folks of Jamaica. The only concerts were mostly limited to jazz concerts which, owing to the ticket prices, could only be attended by the rich.

Curiously enough, sound systems were rather common in the island and recording facilities were cheaper compared to the Western world. It's these sound systems which became the principal machines for music-making for the islanders: you can say these devices were like the DJ consoles for them. And as for the music itself, it had to be loud and fast- exhilarating enough to take the people out of the moment. Now, the